

Examining Roles of Human and Non-Human in an Anti-Anthropocentric Context

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Introduction

In the evolving landscape of human-technological entanglement, we are compelled to confront the consequences of a reality that is simultaneously hyper-connected and profoundly isolated. The phenomenon of techno-destiny, as outlined by Lovink, is no longer a theoretical abstraction but an observable condition: a societal hook-up to networks, platforms, and digital presences that both promise and impede intimacy. Historically, proximity operated as a catalyst for connection, generating communal consensus and shared social landscapes. Yet, with the proliferation of digital interfaces, proximity is reconstituted, fragmented into non-physical channels that attempt, and often fail, to replicate the embodied experience of being-with-others. Social media, in this context, does not merely mediate human connection; it dislocates it, extracting the physical from the process and rendering connectivity a commodity. The result is a paradoxical landscape of hyper-individuality, where the tools designed to connect us extend our isolation and accelerate the circulation of attention as a resource.

This tension between digital immersion and human agency resonates with Hannah Arendt's notion of organized loneliness, revealing a structure where systemic forces orchestrate our engagement with technology in ways that both exploit and amplify the human craving for intimacy. Within these conditions, our attention—a resource at once finite and fundamental—becomes a medium of capital accumulation, an exchange through which humans inadvertently invest in their own diminishment. The extended machine, sustained by human participation, occupies both physical and non-physical spaces, creating a loop in which the human desire for connection is repeatedly deferred. The implications of this dynamic are manifold: as individuals, as communities, and as participants in a global socio-technical system, we are compelled to question the ethical, aesthetic, and practical consequences of our techno-social engagement.

Through a careful survey of American social behaviors, such as the decline of physical togetherness and the paradoxical rise of non-human companionship, Thompson's research exemplifies the consequences of a digitalized sociability. Here, the posthuman condition intersects with observable practices: our attention is divided, our desires mediated, and our relational fields expanded beyond traditional physical limitations into realms of augmented presence. The cyborg metaphor, articulated through Braidotti and Clough, becomes essential in understanding this shift—not merely as a theoretical abstraction but as a lived experience, in which digital and non-digital selves co-occupy, clone, and diverge from one another. The challenge becomes one of sustaining agency, cultivating ethics, and navigating the emergent

possibilities of human-nonhuman interrelations in a landscape increasingly dominated by algorithmic logic and capitalized attention.

This inquiry is further illuminated by artistic and narrative examples, from the visceral futurism of *The Terminator* to poetic renderings such as *Cyborg Nostalgia*, which trace the interstitial spaces between human longing and machinic mediation. These texts illustrate the temporal and spatial dimensions of techno-destiny: the collapse of past, present, and future into a continuum where human agency is both augmented and constrained. In parallel, field investigations, including digital integration polls and textile-based experiments, explore the operationalization of these concepts. The practical work, from glitch-centered textile production to cooperative human-machine improvisation, not only articulates but enacts theoretical insights, highlighting the productive friction between human intentionality and machinic constraints.

The framework of this research, therefore, is both reflective and experimental, recognizing the symbiotic, sometimes antagonistic, interplay between theory and practice. It interrogates the ethical contours of posthumanity, questions the distribution of attention as a resource, and proposes methodologies that resist linear, deterministic approaches to technological engagement. By situating human agency within these overlapping spheres—digital, non-digital, individual, communal, ethical, aesthetic—the research seeks to illuminate the complex dynamics of contemporary life, opening avenues for reflective, participatory, and creative interventions that address both the symptoms and the structural conditions of techno-mediated isolation.

Reading Notes: Notes on Loneliness

In the reading we get introduced to the concept of techno-destiny, which is briefly expressed as our attachment to certain technologies, or being hooked-up. (Lovink, vol. 01)

It's interesting to dissect this concept to reasoning and consequences. Social media in a way redefined the rules for intimacy and being 'social'. Traditionally, proximity established the catalyst for connectivity and generating communities of shared consensus.

With the creation of the internet, the nature of proximity got split into multiple facets, which is where apps tried to address often separately, and sometimes collectively, in an attempt to dislocate the physical condition and establish a digital alternative that can be capitalised on. So in a way, social media disintegrated the idea of connectivity, successfully dislocating its physical components, but since the result was not connected to the process, the capitalisation built on it generated more individuality, rather than substituting physical connectivity.

The reading refers to Hannah Arendt's definition of organized loneliness and totalitarian movements. This provokes an interesting hypothesis. The amount of immersion we experience through the digitization of visual and informational channels is deeply backed by monetized interests. Interests that, presumably, so massively ahead of what they would be if our lives would be grounded in 'real' activities, so much so it enforces a constant and increasing date of digitization and immersion. This poses a question, what is the quality found within that state of immersion, or in the process, attracting those with monetized interests to mine it for profit. In this reading note, I aim to create arguments that highlight possible explanations and outcomes with this paradigm through the reading.

The article cuts across the concept and the consequences of anti-social revolution (Lovink, vol. 01) that was given birth through an intricate web of technology uprising, and capitalization on the untapped potential of our semi-dormant existence. This is a connection to the article, 'Why Americans Stopped Hanging Out', which is discussed in a separate reading note.

What is interesting is that decline is entirely self-generated, it came through a very controversial dynamic where we as a population decided to substitute sites of connection and intimacy with tools of superhuman accessibility. Along with my research, I aim to investigate not only how and why this equation was created, but also how it can contain spaces for active responses and creative strategies. This transition from the social into the antisocial cannot be

actively acknowledged during its early stages, gaining access to superhuman connectivity is an expensive process, it relies and consumes a vital source that we as humans overlook, which is our attention.

The transaction where we exchange spans of our attention into the prolongation of the machine leads us to be constantly devoid of the sufficient amounts needed to practice our dynamism, with these levels of attention starvation, we are faced with a paradox where we are stuck in that loop. With no patience for recharging, and constantly being surrounded by sources of depletion, we are literally caught in a prison of our own making. Much like *The Terminator*, the machine used human practices to update the code of existence and inject alternate practices that were created on the basis of a very human trait, profiting.

What's interesting in this black-hole pattern is our increasing hunger for practicing what's increasingly becoming inaccessible through technological occupation. As we spent decades' 89worth of attention on the progression of the machine, through usage and feedback, it actively occupied many of the physical spaces. The internet, much like a poltergeist in the non-physical sense, could only be manifested into reality through a vessel. Essentially, through vesselization of our physical existence, we allowed it to occupy physical spaces.

What this means, from my point of view, is creating extra layers of inaccessibility to rehabilitate and reclaim these spaces, as the solution is purely paradoxical. In order to organize and create a communal return, large amounts of collective human attention is required, while as aforementioned, we are constantly at an all time low.

This chronic loneliness is to be questioned in its human origins through distinctions from collective cultural social awkwardness expressed in some western societies, such as England, which is modernly famous for its preferred solitude and individualism (Lovink, vol. 01), or male loneliness syndrome that is coming to existence. While Lovink creates clear differentiation in nature between global loneliness and localized loneliness, I tend to disagree. They actually share more in common, than what they exhibit in differences.

The internet, as a structure, and as a set of rules, is brought into creation through western eye of supply and demand. I would even make the argument that the connectivity of the internet was initially launched to supplement the modern absence of colonization, the west has always been direly seeking establishing presence in multiple places, in an attempt perhaps to show disdain with the given physical spaces, or chronically seeking 'more'. After the independence of colonies, this cross-cultures presence was dimmed, which can explain creating ethereal channels which western influence can be yet again fueled, while also feeding the desire for connectivity while not really feeding it, but using that need to fuel the machine for further

progression. The internet was never meant to connect, it was meant to open a tunnel which troops can quietly pass and infiltrate.

Reading Notes: Why Americans Suddenly Stopped Hanging Out

In this article by Derek Thompson, published in the Atlantic, he discusses the case of American loneliness as a subject of post-internet reformation of society. He refers to statistics showing the decline of Americans joining collective activities by 30-50% over the span of the past twenty years. One of the interesting things mentioned in the reading is the referral to a counter argument to loneliness, based on the fact that the morphology and texture of aloneness has shifted. That it is no longer ground in physical distance and boundaries. That digital tools allow us to redefine togetherness. This requires critical viewing as a hypothesis. I am immediately drawn to wonder, if this is indeed the case, then what creates the excess of desire that is clearly stifled by lack of resources? While romanticizing solitude is not infant in artistic and eccentric contexts, we are introduced to a wave of literature highlighting a modern sense of solitude that is being introduced and formed in multiple facets. This means that the new generation of redefined connectivity isn't creating the desired influence of its users.

"I don't think hanging out more will solve every problem. But I do think every social crisis in the U.S. could be helped somewhat if people spent a little more time with other people and a little less time gazing into digital content that's designed to make us anxious and despondent about the world." (Thompson). This premise strikes me as problematic in its essence, but not in its featured object. I do share the same sentiment, that the digital content is 'somewhat' accidentally designed to make us anxious, and prolongs a certain state of trance, but I do not stand on the same side of spending time with people as a solution. To me, this comes across as seeking a solution to a symptom, which can be effective within its own limitations. However, not addressing the ground that was fertilized in preparation of a digital occupation would mean not reflecting on how we as society failed our own interests, and favored capitalist and totalitarian benefits. The way we globally accessed the cultivation of this updated culture that supports aloneness and often punishes togetherness must be assessed and reviewed for possible reparations within the social structure.

Thompson discusses one of the rising trends, which is that Americans doubled the amount of time spent with their pets over the last 20 years. This is curious from a posthuman view. In its essence, the past century was marked by an excessively anthropocentric way of life that left very little space for the non-human. The presence of the non-human in non-essential urges was limited to being complementary in terms of spending 'attention' on it, as I discussed in the

principle of attention as a source in my previous reading note. Backed by Thompson's example, it's evident how the non-human is invited and occupying personal spaces more than before. The unfulfilled closeness desires are being stifled continuously by a directive updated structure of the politics of being, which would explain the reasoning for inviting pets, digital entities, and hybrid beings into sharing the space - in both physical and ethereal senses -. None of my produced literature aims to undermine the value of posthuman entities, on the contrary, I don't see them as participants in a catastrophic present, or a cataclysmic future, but rather condolent and enriching presence that carry potential for failing to eliminate aloneness, as it doesn't possess the qualities sufficient to practice said endeavor. Subjecting non-human entities into serving the human-loneliness syndrome is itself a topic to be investigated critically in order to better understand and reposition our relationships to the non-human, and the posthuman.

This dynamic grows even more interestingly when we look at it through a generational lens. In the article, Thompson refers to the scale where this affects teenagers specifically, experiencing a more drastic decline in the amount of their social inclusion in comparison with 20 years ago. Up until this moment, there are still generations that lived before many of the large relevant human inventions, and over the past 20 years, there are generations being born knowing this frame of connectivity as the sole paradigm available for social fulfilment. Digitally is surpassing a syndrome or a parallel presence, it is essentially hyper-replacing physicality within human memory. Within the next 80 years, there will be no generations that lived through experiences grounded in physicality before the creation of digital implementations. Understanding this as artists, historians, humanities scholars gives us an opportunity to place the human memory within our effective practices, generating the urgency for building and positioning stances within our productions.

Reading Notes: Terminator

In the terminator, we see signs of the direction the western, or the Hollywood representation of the collective human consensus of the “robotic future”. From my standing point, and through the studies carried in the previous year, I recognized the ‘post-human’ turn intersecting with an artistic production – albeit commercial, that quality means relying on targeting untapped attractions within the audience, so it does carry the potential for an argument justifying it as a tool for social representation – In this field note, I aim to investigate different facets of the production that touch upon the perception of the posthuman dynamic, especially in relation to anthropocentrism that is portrayed in the movie, in an attempt to collect and organize a differential analysis between an earlier point in history and a current one.

My initial impression creates a premise of consequential relationship, where the culturally provided - despite substantiating content based on target audience - creates a starting point for developing critical and cautious approach to the posthuman turn, while still not informing our modern decisions, creating a paradoxical presence within the posthuman without acknowledging it in attempt to avoid uniting actions with the deep-based fears of an anti-anthropocentric future.

The Explosive Arrival of the Mechanic Other

Traveling through the time portal, from year into 2029, leaping into 1984, James Cameron chooses to highlight that moment with a bang. We see explosive lighting strikes rapidly around the area of arrival. While this naturally serves the role of attractive lights and effects, it also highlights the artistic choice of the initial impression. It’s not a subtle, integrative appearance, but rather an aggressive hard launch. As Schwarzenegger comes into focus, naked, as we later get told by the protagonist, Kyle Reese, that it has to do with the ‘science’ of time teleport that leads to clothing disintegrating in the process. Simple reading would reveal that monetizing Arnlod’s steel buns are affirmatively the true reasoning for said time portal malfunction.



Policies of Belonging and Access

What's an interesting component for analysis however emerges in the choice of the villain in clothing afterwards. Despite being a cyborg, capable of reading and algorithmizing observed social contexts and behaviors, he opts in for a 80s punk look. The leather, social misfit, dangerous type. These visual queues created in the movie production leads us to understand what Cameron wanted to present. This representation means that the mechanical 'bad guy', is not subtle, as it possesses brutal forces, so there is no need to be part of society and go through proper channels to perform, in the movie, the machine rewrites a new way of conduct. This comes into paradoxical importance as the terminator is taking a human form, as we understand later in the movie to be able to infiltrate survivors camps in the year 2029 and 'terminate them'. What's paradoxical is despite possessing said image, they don't perform humanely, meaning they only go through these visual transformations only to access human exclusive spaces, portraying the sole necessity of the presentation as crossing the threshold of anthropocentric fence.

Once the terminator gains access, it then uses the non-human parts to hyperperform in these spaces beyond the capabilities of individual or collective output of the human, hence rewriting the rules of power exchange. These observations lead me to solidify a certain understanding of

how the posthuman future was represented in this type of narrative, with 2029 a few years ahead, this 'futuristic' production wasn't referring to the far future. It notified the near future, as it carries on a reading of the initiation birth of the digital at a time and foresees its developments. What's striking in said narrative is that it revolved around how violently, not only anti-anthropocentric, but anti-anthropocene in general. Losing control in the story meant increasingly losing existence, as the machine will terminate the human through human-made tools, and using human appearance itself later on to infiltrate and execute their purposes. This not so subtle threat to human beings is replaced - literally - by the machine through humanity's own cultivation of the techno-destiny.

This narrative, from as early as the 80s, is still circulating often jokingly, or with an underlying hint of larger fear, in regards to the future of humanity post AI. However, despite being such an aging concept, it is not informing many of the personal and collective choices we practice. As I will discuss in a later reading note, we are rushing rapidly towards fulfilling our techno destiny, this doesn't necessarily indicate a catastrophic future or impending cataclysm, but it doesn't mean we are surpassing theorizing integrations and preparing for it immediately into the techno integration itself. This creates the uncertainty that leads to the exaggerated futures narratives portrayed in said movies. This comes into importance as an object to analyse in regards to a premise of a later field note on how integration that is grounded within an ethical frame is near impossible due to the climate provided by techno-profitists.

Reading Notes: Braidotti, Rosi. The Posthuman, 2013, pp. 89–104.

In the reading Braidotti positions the issues of technology as central to the posthuman predicament, in the transformative and ethical sense. Essentially, the strategies of digital hyper-inclusion and consciousness-transference to the digital are companions to an updated understanding of what is meant to be anthropocene in the current modern context. I agree initially with the relative proximity of these concepts. I, however, feel conflicted when thinking that an updated envisioning of the posthuman subjectivity would naturally lead to a matching code of ethics that supports the posthuman predicament.

The hypothesis proposed relies on the developed and extrapolated values that would necessarily empower the balance of post-anthropocentric realities, in a way that performs the sustainability of the shifted reality. Subsequently, this encompasses the need for humanities thinkers and practitioners to, firstly, take on a mantle of posthumanist urgency and reorientation of objectives philosophies, second, do so in real time in order to express effective strategies while providing sufficient duration threshold for the updated practices to be introduced and familiarized with, and finally, to be able to do so in accordance with an 'ethical' understanding of the posthuman predicament and the role of the anthropocene in the upcoming chapter. This trifecta of critical questionings regarding the active role of the posthumanist literature and practices cause me to generate a sense of uncertain urgency.

Braidotti refers to Patricia Clough's revelation that we have become 'biomediated bodies' (Clough). She then launches the premise that cyborgs are the dominant social and cultural formations that are active throughout the social fabric. This becomes a site of critical examination within the subject of investigating the posthuman manifestations and transactions, especially when brought into the contexts of establishing an understanding of the concept of aloneness discussed in the previous notes, and the urgency to substantiate a speculative practice-grounded actions.

One is bound to think subsequently, if our updated state is becoming cyborgs in order to operate commonly within the social fabric, what kind of transactions took place in order for this

infused form to be generated? If an increased number of traits was to occupy the same space, something would need to be naturally pushed outside the borders of said space, which leaves us to wonder what was lost or gained during these steps of becoming with the machine. However, we no longer occupy the physical space of our presence exclusively. We have progressively spread our reach, through and resulting in the cyborg state, onto multiple areas of existence. During last year's research report, I have referred to the state of cloning ourselves into virtual presences that are tied in objectives to perform non-physical practices. In my current research, I update this understanding into a different form. We have effectively extended our non-physical form, while occupying the same physical form. The reasoning there is a distinction lies in the following, implying that our presence in the non-physical is purely cloned into alternate presences means that we don't share the same expense of resources, except perhaps in the moment of emancipation of said presences. While the reality, as illustrated in my reading note. "Notes on Loneliness", illustrates that we are spending a general resource taxing our presences - and abilities - within the non-physical. All these engines that we are actively or passively used to alternate the geographical and grounded capabilities of our non-physical selves in accelerated pace is a process that is exhausting the main human resource, attention. In this narrative, we are caught in a loop of practicing what I will refer to as super-reach, in search for more connectivity, while using tools that are both prolonging the state of seeking, and delaying a sufficient outcome that replenishes the source of attention based on purpose fulfillment.

Reading Notes: The Matrix

In *The Matrix*, the interplay between illusion and consciousness is not presented as a mere cinematic spectacle, but rather as a philosophical investigation into the conditions of being, perception, and control within a posthuman landscape. The film's aesthetic and narrative architecture situate the viewer inside a digitally manufactured simulacrum — a parallel existence that is both familiar and foreign, known and unknowable. The body, here, becomes an obsolete vessel, a container of sensory deception, while the mind is enslaved to the machinery of perception. This inversion of reality, in its structure and essence, echoes Baudrillard's simulacra, yet what is compelling in *The Matrix* is not its visual citation of hyperreality, but its insistence that liberation itself is mediated by the very system it seeks to undo.

Neo's awakening is thus not a spiritual rebirth but a reprogramming — a shifting of consciousness that remains inseparable from the digital apparatus. The so-called “real world,” scarred and metallic, does not offer redemption, but rather another mode of subjugation; its liberation narrative is coded within machinic language, and its promise of authenticity remains contaminated by dependency on technology. This renders the act of emancipation a recursive illusion — an update of consciousness that is still bound to the infrastructure it critiques. In this sense, *The Matrix* performs an early cinematic manifestation of what Braidotti would later define as the posthuman predicament: an existence in which agency is technologically mediated, and the distinction between human and machine dissolves into functional hybridity.

The film's cyborg bodies — wired, pierced, and plugged into both reality and simulation — operate as visual metaphors for our collective condition of techno-destiny. They are the biomediated bodies that Clough and Braidotti articulate, positioned between presence and data, flesh and code. The cables entering the spine and skull become contemporary umbilical cords, feeding both the illusion of individuality and the reality of dependence. It is within this symbiosis that the posthuman condition crystallizes: not as a linear transcendence of the

human, but as an entangled continuity, a choreography of control and surrender, of data and desire.

Morality and ethicality within *The Matrix* emerge as ambiguous terrains. The question of what constitutes a “real” choice is consistently undermined by the recognition that all decisions are processed within systems of preconditioned data. This recalls the ethical paralysis described in my reflective note on modern ethics — where the illusion of autonomy is maintained while systemic mechanisms predetermine outcomes. Neo’s decision to choose the red pill is framed as radical agency, yet it is still a decision permitted within the architecture of control. The ethical subject, then, becomes a function of design, and resistance to a programmed variable within the machine’s narrative of equilibrium.

What fascinates me further is how *The Matrix* externalizes loneliness as an inevitable byproduct of awakening. The posthuman self, once aware of its constructed environment, finds no genuine home — neither in the simulation nor in the so-called real. This mirrors the sense of posthuman aloneness I explored in my notes on digital integration: the recognition that our non-physical selves, extended across digital architectures, are estranged from both presence and proximity. Neo, in his detachment, becomes a symbol of contemporary alienation — a being both liberated and exiled by his own consciousness. His ascension into the machine’s language, his ability to manipulate the code, signifies not victory but assimilation; he becomes fluent in the syntax of control.

In aesthetic terms, the film’s signature green tint functions as a chromatic metaphor for artificial life — a hue suspended between organic and synthetic. This color palette, together with the perpetual rain, metallic soundscapes, and digitized stutter of motion, forms a visual poetics of the posthuman environment: sterile, recursive, and beautiful in its decay. Time, within this space, does not progress — it loops, updates, glitches. This temporal instability recalls the textile experiment described in my field note, where the glitch becomes a site of creation and meaning-making. In both domains, the malfunction is not a failure but an aperture — a space through which the limits of systemized reality can be temporarily transcended.

Ultimately, *The Matrix* reads as a cinematic prophecy of attention scarcity and digital exhaustion. It stages the human as both the battery and the consumer of its own mediated experience, perpetually sustaining the machine that consumes it. The film does not ask whether we are free, but whether freedom, as a concept, can survive mediation. In that question lies its enduring resonance: the unsettling realization that our own digital existences are iterations of the same circuitry — endlessly connected, endlessly deferred.

Field Note: Reflective Literature on Ethicality in Modern Times

What does it mean to be ethical in our modern times? In my view, being ethical as a concept no longer can exist in the current atmosphere. I'm observing no route for individuals or small communities that fall under upper-middle/middle class to generate sufficient potency within decision making that would lead to significant or prolonged "correctness" or modification towards the "ethical" on a large scale.

What creates the impotency in the magnitude of aforementioned groups in contrast with the entities at the global decision making level is primarily the neoliberal distribution of power, and disseminating a sense of dormancy. Effectively dislocating tools of action from individuals, and relocating them to groups of wealth and power – often connected – while maintaining a facade of accessibility, is the headline of the socio-ecopolitical scene. Evidently expressed in how the arching capitalist goals of global power units are contrasting, and often contradicting, with sustainable benefits of individuals and small communities.

Ethicality in Times of War

Being ethical in these times becomes loaded with more layers of complexity as we are confronted with global waves of violence, expressed in wars, culture-infiltrations and destabilizing schemes, organized group-based aggressions. This contrast of existence under different conditions reveals points of interest within the paradigm of being ethical. Our affordance to become ethical then lies in being provided with a spectrum of choices where we are able to sustain essential facets of being, while additionally adopting a non-interruptive layer of externalized behavior. This ethical behavior is often associated with minimum consequences, provided we view it within the context of current popular practices; dietary, energy-related, carbon footprint, and so, with the exception of exile as an extreme approach. Tools of being ethical in aforementioned practices are offered, sometimes through entities capitalising on the growing preference to said choices, paradoxically applying a counterproductive taint to the practice.

Reflection on the Motivation of Ethicality

Consequentialism seems to be informing the motivation for most of our modern ethical endeavors. The closer we look, the more ethnocentric evidence we find. Particularly when looking at political and global conflicts, for instance what's happening in Sudan (Al Jazeera). This is an interesting companion to the post-human future to examine as the dynamo of ethical organization; noticeably I am not referring to ethical in the sense of inclusive and equal codes, but rather in the overarching sense of the word expressed in often violent and extreme polarizations. Returning exclusion and increasing ethnocentric-based practices invites me to consider two aspects. The first being, would it be plausible that a growing perception that communities' reality is being consumed by a larger global reality fueled by the political economy machine essentially participating into communities violently reacting into reverse strategies? As we are presented with multiple realities, systematically, through organized media machine performances acting on the behalf of capitalist interests, our own non-global identities are the main stage of demolition.

Interestingly enough, belonging to a global identity itself has its own set of criteria and conditions of access. This creates a paradox of perception and reality, essentially, generating a crisis that would be a companion onto the posthuman turn, not directly a participant into the turn, but rather a parallel relative chain of reactions.

If we follow said premise, this would intrinsically translate into spaces of actions where reassessing the role of cultural-specificity and our preconceived notions of ethical-interaction with the other becomes more of a necessity in order to safely move forward. Questions touching upon the placement of diverse cultures as a fetish, or often a monument, within western communities on one hand, and dangerous formations of white nationalism on the other hand start to come into focus. Reunderstanding the surroundings symptoms of the, possibly, faulty approach to globalism, and the hyperaccelerating reach it had through modern tools, offers itself as a site of critical examination in order to start the process of developing an 'ethical' update.

Relating Back to My Practice

As an artist, I have actively avoided the inclusion of my personal cultural influences into my practice, due to ambiguity of routes to safely locate them within a western context. Through the years, I haven't managed to substantiate a methodology of channeling or practicing facets of culture-specific processes or productions, post being informed by, not the xenophobic hostility, but through the ethics of viewing other cultures that carries suspicions of performing as an

embellishment, essentially evacuating previously cultivated sites of meaning within these productions/works.

This, once again, touches on the sense of enforced globality and how it generates part of our ethical coding in the modern times. With the constant state of surveillance, we are constantly in a state of continuous updating the visibilities and the validity of who we are, in accordance with our affiliations contexts and movement, or in a state of stubbornness in rejection of the pace, both operated primarily by posthuman tools exploited.

The state of tension between who we need to be, and who we are, is a clear call for action. Inability to reconcile the spectrum of givens with the desired progress creates social glitches, as sites for influence. This helps me highlight the role of ethicality as a global concept within my practice, extrapolated onto that such outdated concept cannot continue to exist post its processing through oppositely-interests machines. New forms of presences are of urgency to occur within my practice, expressed in, and optimistically informing, not only my choices of research and visual productions, but additionally my adaptation of tools and positioning of glitching as processes.

Field Note: Digital Integration Poll

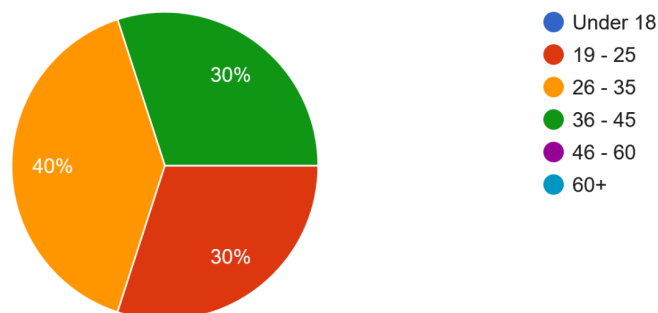
The poll was initially created as an idea to gather a sample of understanding from the surrounding the relative effects connecting digital behaviors and social integration. I attempted to create a number of questions that invite the participants to explore that connection themselves through being offered an inquiry surrounding it.

This questionnaire operates on a starting hypothesis, linking the idea of digital emergence to craving more connection, and resenting the levels of digital integration practiced through the active and passive participants. The premise is being channeled, as we read in the reading note on Why Americans Suddenly Stopped Hanging Out, by that rules of aloneness have been updated and thus inviting more connectedness than appears to the nostalgic eye.

In this field note, I aim to sample a method of investigating the general consensus intersecting with these principles. The goal is not necessarily to be able to establish a definitive quantitative input, but to experiment with ways of questioning and answering that generate a dialog, in hopes of applying it on progressively larger scales and forms.

How old are you

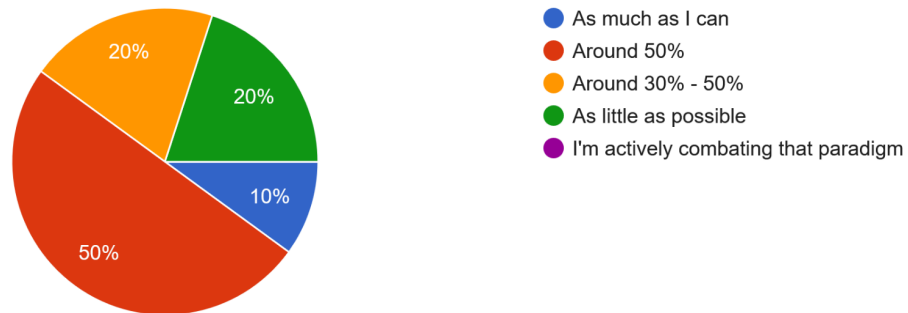
10 responses



Using age as an initial control group to determine the approximate level of posthuman convergence that accompanied their upbringing. As mentioned earlier in the research, the levels where this disconnection and lack of proximity strike begin to show variations expressed within different age groups.

Do you use software/apps to do some activities that can be done directly by you?

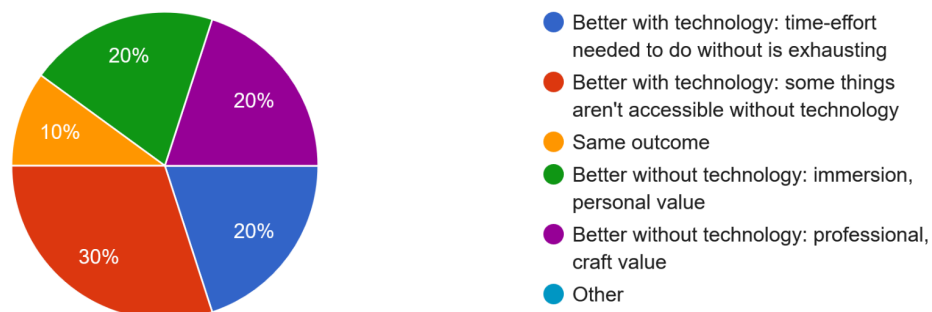
10 responses



This question aims to create a site for investigation found in the extent we are comfortable with our digital integration, when compared against our innate/gained ability – physically speaking – to conduct the same tasks. Inquiries surrounding ease of access, informational connectedness found in the modern age, and the updated social behaviors of monetizing time as a unit of value emerge when starting said conversation.

Do you enjoy the outcomes as much as if you would have done it without technology?

10 responses

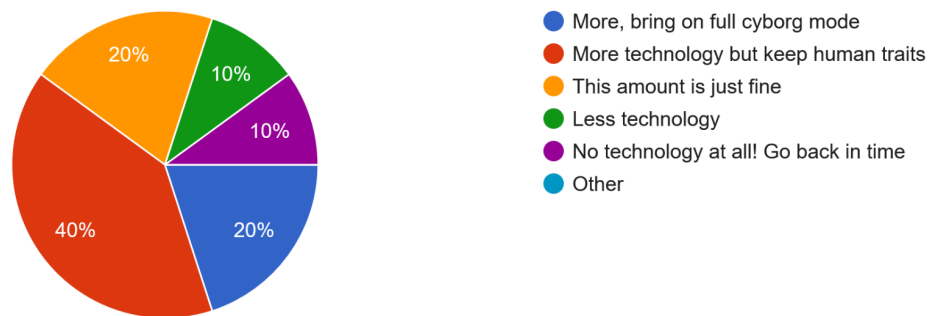


The previous arguments surrounding ease of access begin to emerge again in this question, which serves the continuity of the conversation and the ability to pinpoint different

connections within the paradigm. One of the answers that strike me the most was stating that it is of the same outcome to conduct activities both digitally and physically, which is a nod to what Deleuze calls, 'becoming machine', in the sense of dispersing the previously inherited lines that defined – and assigned – different natures and consequences, and extrapolated outcomes. Essentiality is becoming a second nature to digitality, progressively as we continue ahead both in a linear time sense and branching through our updated policies and devices. Losing a connectivity digital device is gaining an accelerated importance and impact, becoming an equivalent of losing a digital limb, operating on the previously mentioned notion that we have successfully extended our being onto occupying digital spaces.

Would you like to be more or less integrated with technology?

10 responses

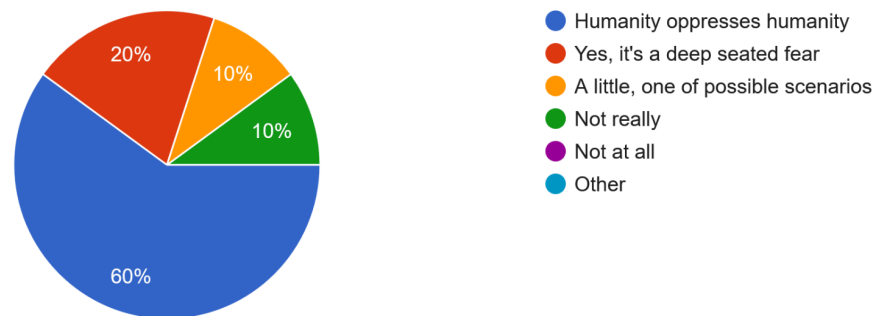


This is where it goes pivotally interesting. Especially in relation to the next parts of the questionnaire to come. The level of reach of digitally is so popularly accepted, that we are already looking forward to a further updated system, despite the given understanding that this goes with a parallel path of shrinking human intervals in favor of saving attention energy for the digital immersion. Where intersectionality grows exciting is to examine the answers where people are seeking optimized, more advanced technologies that become a part of the equation where human traits continue to prosper and thrive. This leads us to think about the ethos mentioned by Rosi Braidotti in *The Posthuman* (Braidotti 211–264). She aims to establish a narrative where our collective and communal research and updating a way to tackle the repositioning and the transitions of the human, non human, the physical, and the non physical, is essential to a sustainable posthuman existence. This enlightens the areas of urgency to

discover equations that resist the processing of political economy, and try to conclude routes of actions that promote 'ethical' integration.

Do you worry about a future where AI oppresses humanity?

10 responses



This part of the questionnaire is of a personal importance to my curiosity. Viewing different forms of artistic and scientific literature that refers to alternative outcomes of human - non human integration ignite questioning about the reflection of these theories in grounded realities. However, there seems to be a wide recognition that the influence of the human on facets addressed by cataclysm digital events scenarios is already catastrophic without the extra layer of nonphysicality. This comes into play when discussing codes of ethics to be practiced, and the very meaning of ethics itself, which I address in my reflective literature on ethicality in modern times.

Do you think we as individuals are enabling excessive technological use in society?

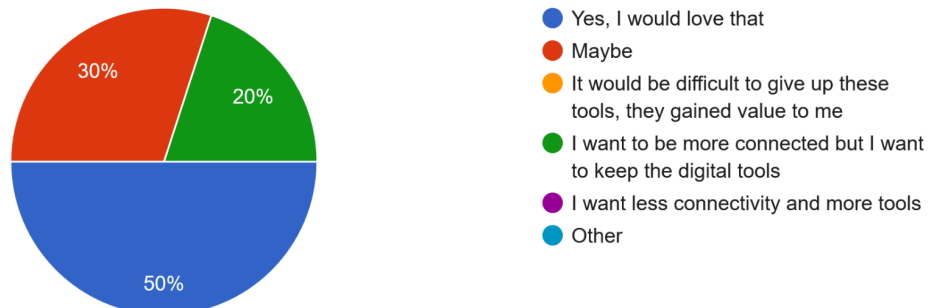
10 responses



The above question aims to propose the questions of what levels of immersion or digital integration are deemed excessive and whether usage is the main dynamo of said dynamic.

Would you like to be more connected and communal if that would mean giving up digital tools?

10 responses



This emerges of relative interest to the previous question regarding the desire to be further more digitally inclined, which had positive reaction from most participants in favor of advancing technological integration. However, here, when connectivity and communal sentiment comes into play, it seems to ignite a memory, or perhaps a nostalgic reference, especially when considering the age groups of the participants. Evidently in this small sample, there is a desire for more connectedness, so much so, it is expressed in reading to reverse the

digital contract transaction of the modern age. I relate this to the reading note on loneliness where I discuss how spending the currency of human attention on digital manifestation prolongs the predicament of posthuman loneliness, which seems to be also linked somewhere in participants minds.

Through this sample testing of conversation points in the digital sphere offers an exciting opportunity for further dialogue within the same topics, in an attempt to provoke a methodology to address our updated identities. While the testing group cannot be deemed statistically valid enabling extrapolation of effective techniques, it reveals a need for discussions that tackle these untapped subjects to match the pace of actions at which we develop to match the update rules of connectivity, let it be new social platform, new laws of conducts, the social-political levels of speech allowance within digital space and how they refract onto physical effects, and the list goes on. In my view, that generates an academic urgency within our practices to practice deacademizing much of the knowledge surrounding subjects of technological integration, and find ways to propose these themes for collective action.

Field Note: Textile Publishing & Encrypted Performances

Traditionally in my embroidery, I relied on a combination of preplanned human input that was used to capture specific moments in retrospect, and applying it through a prolonged automated process. In my field note, I aim to investigate a shifted dynamic where planned human input is minimized, allowing an emergence of a human-centered machine-mediated process that resists automation and repetition, in contrast to the previous process.



In this practice I will employ my own momental span of emotions onto creating and applying narratives with textiles, expressed in embroidering hand motions and gestures of words connected to said state.

Reflection on the Past Methodology

I experimented with a personal way of creating the textile to be used in the design. This methodology entailed creating markings based on how I feel, or a deeply blurred/encrypted version of personal texts, and processing them to be embroidered digitally using the machine.

This process essentially created a combination of a raw human factor channeled into a planned human input, then subjected to a prolonged automated process.

There lies a paradoxical positioning, or rather relative existence of two traditionally opposing forces, where the human input takes a raw and personalized shape that could resist repetition beyond its moment of creation, trapped in a specific unrepeatable moment of time, marking the production through a set of conditions that are so ephemeral, resulting in a singular form. The machine then, without meeting the conditions, is able to trace and create the results previously mentioned. Which then can be endlessly recreated and reworked. This creates new meanings found in clothing used through this methodology.

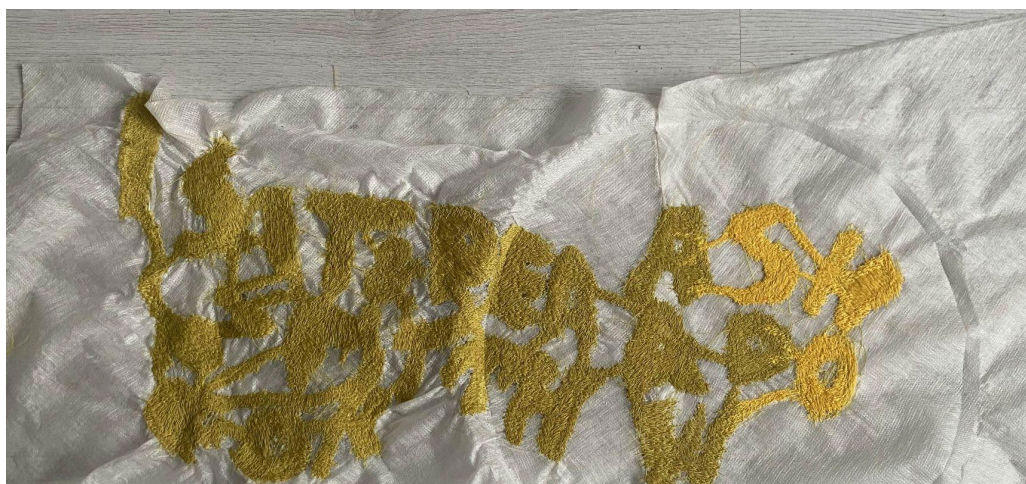
This approach carries an interesting reconfiguration of dynamics. The configuration occurs when pointed out that the machine is not designed for the aforementioned objective. While generally and theoretically fulfilling the conditions needed to create these objects, the machine has already been loaded with a history of interaction that created an imaginary limit of the potential. This essentially means that the human is always certain about the outcome, there are no untapped possibilities, the result is based on functionality, and if the condition of functionality is fulfilled then the outcome is predetermined.

During my experiment, I aim to capitalize on the glitches occurring due to the incompatibility of my project with the functionality of the machine. The textile production relied on the spaces lying outside functionality, let that be dysfunctionality, or altered functionality, to be produced. Criteria such as not using a sturdy fabric to stabilize the movement, encouraging a destabilized unanchored movement, and undetermined points of pause/continue, were used to push the limits of glitches even further, offering the machine a chance to co-operate rather than be operated.

This informs both my research and my practice. Through scanning, it is evident that my work within fashion design, both conceptually, and materially, is above investigating and symbiose with the spaces falling outside the predetermined factors of functionality.

Process Development

The new process becomes a site for substantial changes and comparisons. Through these current mechanisms, preplanned human input is expressed in knowing the text or movement to



be turned into textile.
Inclusion of human ephemeral and momental

influence begins to emerge at the following part where hand movement is used to create the shapes. While attempts to ensure unison were exerted, there seems to be an autonomous emotional-physical reflectory system that resists automation, during the process where the machine provides a continuous non-flexible input represented in the constant move of the needle in the same position. This scales the impact of the human factor on the visual outcome, expressed in how in that moment the physical reactions took said shape, and how it affects the next placement of stitch, and so on created a chain of machine mediated, human centered textilular reactions.

Another point of comparison is the presence of glitch and the capitalisation on them. In this paradigm, the site for glitches becomes both human and machine, both parties share the potential of glitches, offering separate, colliding, or oppository spaces for performing outside the functionality. In the previous methodology, glitching was more forced into the machine, inviting it. Through the changes in the way of working, glitching becomes a semi-independent process – conditioned only by being operational – that continues naturally and impulsively. This doesn't necessarily mean that the machine in that specific scenario is sentient or cooperative in an autonomous manner, but it offers a shifted mechanism of interacting with the machine outside the dichotomy of sentient/non sentient. Spaces of being outside this dichotomy is being constantly brought up in urgencies as the posthuman turn is taking place, essentially outdating that differentiation, marking it as invalid.

Glitching Together

This, conceptually, offers an alternative understanding of giving up part of the free-will, the anthropocentrism, and sharing parts of existence with the machine, contrasting with the scenario offered in the previous reading of 'The Terminator'. While in this example, the potential is expressed within the limitation of occupying the glitching spaces through individual work, conceptually, these spaces can also be sites for collection action, which inform my practice in the context of collaborative prospects. Multiplying the sources of glitches and providing the environment for numerous expressions of each source would theoretically, and endlessly, produce infinite forms of productions and design manifestations, in this field note, within fashion and textiles.

Textile Publishing

Another intersection emerges throughout the process is activating textile publishing as a design objective. Textile becomes an alternate entity where sites of meanings are forming through the glitches, and the gestures expressed. In the second example, a less encrypted version of embroidery was used, relocating the product of dysfunctionality within the movement and the update methodology rather than encryption, while still offering obstacles against clarity, inviting personalized variations of understanding. The textile then reproduces

itself as a vessel of meaning by its reproductions filtered through multiple usages or perceptions.

Field Note: Poem - Cyborg Nostalgia

Proximity.. Of Infinity
Being all, being none
Being a shadow, a filament of light
Unknown
Quantifiable
Denied the right to un-be
Proximity
Failed design, failed to design
Trying to be, through the desire
To have the power to decide
To come undone,
Remade, redone
What does it mean
To be through the lens
To become, only to be planted still,
As a seed of the unliving
As a memorial of what happened
In the before times,
After the dust has settled
And the crowns were shattered,
Letting a new
A new age
A new site
A new set of eyes,
That cannot be shut
How can all,
Become one?
Despite the storm
Raging, screaming,

Revolting against the wind,
It is made of what it resents.
It is made of what it hates,
It is made of what it loves,
It is made of what it is.
To denounce the flesh,
To seek a vessel where it ends,
Another form of being,
Another destiny to crave,
Machine made prophecy
A promise,
Unfulfilled.

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Field Note: Developing Practices Tied in Research as A Circular Process

From the research, a number of valid methodologies are offered to be extrapolated, further substantiating and informing routes and actions of practice that avoid linear destiny of many design modes of production, into an adaptable, growing, alternative body of reaction.

For the most of my study, my design work has been dedicated to portraying deeply human attachments, residing in extreme emotionally distressing experiences, and uploading said narratives onto a superhuman image. Taking on a companion of a non-human, traditionally rigid presence, to narrate humanely complex literature, has been an equation I aimed to maintain. My emphasis on the human was my own way to resist an observed transition towards a digital necessity growing as a condition for inclusion and monetized progress within the design field, and to be fair, across other fields as well.

Through examining literature that explains some of the complicated facets of techno-destiny and cyborg predicament, I am developing a better understanding of the upcoming phase of practice.

Sited Glitching - Cooperative Happenings as Source of Research

When one examines the design machine expressed in conceptualizing and production within the modern times, we notice the eccentric desire of control through assimilation. Reproducing culture and symbols through commodified wearings is, essentially, the cornerstone of modern fashion design. Studying groups who would be targeted for the production, forecasting outcomes, tailored to be sold not sold through being tailored. This becomes one of the areas where I attempt to tackle within my work. Coming from a familiar clumsy childhood inspiration, where mistakes are pointed out. Capitalising on said outcome, and integrating into a practice, establishes duality of outcomes that can be observed through the speciality caused through the amalgamation of personalized non-reproducible images with the tools of design practice, while the process of allowing glitches itself means actively combating the notion of control and coexisting in a cooperative synopsis with happenings. This is in no way an invitation to denounce aspects of human ushering, on the contrary, it is an invitation to

experiment with the limitations of human gestures against our preconceived notions of their definitions.

Often in this document I have referred to collective and communal action. At this conjunction of text, I would like to highlight that it comes of equivalent importance – metaphorically speaking, there is no way to determine a quantified equivalency – that we as practitioners also develop an understanding of our personally natural approach and assign in spaces which can be looked at additionally as sites for research. This is where the value of human directive once again emerges. Dealing in these factors in an attempt to continuously update and generate new definitions and practices that address issues like ethicality and sustainability is an approach I aim to integrate into my approach.

Expectancies of Digital Performances

Through observing different media interactions with the fashion design practice, I grew to a realization that is yet to find its positioning, whether in favor or against, within my practice. While I talked about the cyborg-transformation previously in the document, it's naturally implied that this predicament essentially took place in order to perform within digital spaces, that would later on refract back onto physical spaces. What might not be implied, is how we assimilated non-human commodities, including even behavioral trends, onto digitally performing while developing expectations and drawing results of and based on their performance. Digitally performing has its own rules, it is probably incomparable to physical performance.

This influences a range of decisions to be taken within, not only my practice in my opinion, but rather any current design practice. Social access becoming increasingly conditioned with cyborg privileges is shifting the grounds for how we are able to formulate and establish our practices. Digitally is resisting being classified as additional or supplementary directly into crafting a space of essentiality in order to materialize practice-based outcomes. This is counter-argued in the sense that seeking assimilation into said system would highlight neoliberal interests, even on a small scale.

However, seeking freedom from the performance shackles entails a set of sanctions practiced on the exiled party. While experiencing, or attempting to experience, communal and cooperative meanings, being denied access to monetized values on the basis of inaccessibility is progressively a critical punishment for operating outside digital performance spaces.

This dynamic is an ongoing tension that I experience in my practice, which I try to cultivate into a site for experimental reaction. What I am hoping for through the continuous theorization and reinvestigation of design outcomes and also its surrounding component as a research material is to develop a better understanding on how to perform within these spaces, if at all. Is possessing the tools in itself considered a necessity at the current times? Is the affordance of

digital performance an undermining counter-intuitive practice? The discussion invites more questions for upcoming research.

To situate my practice within a circular relation of design and reflective research is to allow a continuity of questioning that resists the notion of finality. The work itself becomes both the subject and the consequence, unfolding through a system of reactions rather than resolutions. It grows from itself, informed by the very frictions it generates. Each design iteration transforms into a form of research material, and each research reflection materializes into a design impulse, forming a constant motion that refuses to exist in separation.

In this circularity, the human and non-human coexist as collaborators rather than hierarchies, producing a dialogue that escapes the linear expectations of design output. Through this exchange, I find a rhythm where glitching and theorizing, making and reflecting, occur not as distinct phases but as overlapping gestures—each bending into the other, continuously redefining their own relevance.

The practice, then, is not merely to produce but to observe its own becoming; to watch how it reconfigures, contradicts, and re-emerges through its errors, performances, and absences. Within that, the research is not a commentary on design, but its echo—a living document of what has already been enacted and what might still occur. My aim moving forward is to remain within this loop of interdependence, where every attempt to define the practice collapses back into the necessity to reimagine it, again and again, until circularity itself becomes the method, and the method becomes the work.

Conclusion

The synthesis of this research underscores the profound entanglement of human experience with digital, machinic, and posthuman realities. Loneliness, attention scarcity, and the commodification of social presence are not incidental outcomes; they are structural features of a techno-destined society, shaped by the convergence of social media, digital labor, and capitalized attention. Yet, within this landscape, critical openings emerge. Field investigations into digital integration reveal a latent desire for connection, suggesting that while technologies have redefined proximity, they have not eradicated the human imperative for relationality. The experimental work in textiles and human-machine co-creativity further illustrates the potential of material practices to negotiate, disrupt, and reconfigure these techno-social dynamics. Through glitching, improvisation, and cooperative interaction, human agency asserts itself in spaces where the deterministic trajectories of technology are destabilized, opening room for reflection, resistance, and ethical engagement.

The ethical dimension, explored in reflective literature and through the lens of contemporary global challenges, remains central. In a world governed by neoliberal distribution of power and algorithmically mediated norms, the potential for traditional ethical praxis is constrained. However, by critically engaging with posthumanist theory, and by situating artistic and experimental practices as sites of inquiry, new forms of ethicality can emerge—situated, provisional, and responsive to the shifting boundaries of human and nonhuman co-existence. The posthuman condition, then, is not simply a narrative of obsolescence or domination; it is a terrain of negotiation, where the interplay of attention, desire, and agency produces both opportunities and obligations for reflection and intervention.

Moreover, the integration of poetic and narrative frameworks within this research provides a necessary lens for understanding the experiential qualities of posthuman existence. *Cyborg Nostalgia*, for instance, encapsulates the paradoxical simultaneity of being and non-being, of proximity and distance, reminding us that the spaces between human and machine are not only material or functional but affective and temporal. Similarly, cinematic and literary

exemplars illuminate the anticipatory anxieties and ethical dilemmas inherent in technological futurism, while simultaneously offering imaginative frameworks for contemplating possible engagements and resistances. These cultural artifacts function as mirrors and provocations, shaping the questions we ask of both practice and theory.

Finally, this research highlights the imperative of circularity between reflection and practice, between theory and material experimentation. Whether through digital surveys, textile interventions, or conceptual field notes, the work demonstrates that knowledge production is inseparable from experiential engagement, and that iterative processes of creation, observation, and adaptation can yield insights into otherwise opaque systems of techno-social operation. By bridging human intention with machinic logic, by negotiating ethical dilemmas within creative praxis, and by foregrounding the persistent urgency of attention as a finite and essential resource, this research offers both a critical mapping and a methodological pathway toward reconfiguring our relationship to technology, other beings, and the shared spaces we inhabit.

In summation, the posthuman present is neither apocalyptic nor utopian; it is an ongoing negotiation, a field of simultaneous collapse and emergence, of depletion and creativity. Understanding, inhabiting, and intervening within this field requires attentiveness, ethical sensibility, and experimental imagination. The work presented here does not claim to resolve the tensions inherent in techno-destined existence, but rather to illuminate them, to create productive spaces for inquiry, and to propose approaches for cultivating agency, ethical engagement, and communal reconstitution within a world increasingly shaped by the interpenetration of human, nonhuman, and machinic forces.

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